

r/energy

Opinions?? Data Center Water Consumption (AI, Energy, and Data Storage)

Posted by u/JazzlikeAd8934 • 0 points • 5 comments

hi y'all :-) lately i've had this question and i was wondering, how can we really tell how much of what we're doing in our daily lives contribute to this topic? i want to make sure i've got a well grounded environmental sustainability system out here 🙏

Comments

u/Daflehrer1 • 1 points • 2025-10-16 20:28 UTC

I watched this video. It documents how data centers affect individuals, communities, and entire regions. I believe it's worthy of careful consideration. It may also fill in gaps in one's knowledge about data centers.

<https://youtu.be/t-8TDOFqkQA?si=V28Ms9AclgrgkwIW>

u/Sagrilarus • 2 points • 2025-08-20 19:28 UTC

>how can we really tell how much of what we're doing in our daily lives contribute to this topic?

Here's how I'm doing -- **I'm not contributing one iota to this bullshit.** And don't even try to drag me into this conversation. I'd wager not one person that reads this thread has any dog in this hunt and couldn't care less if AI just imploded now instead of in five years once the looting is complete. This is one more thing foisted onto us without our permission or interest.

I actively avoid AI content whenever I can and my personal opinion is that it's a threat to freedom around the world. All of this is one more slice of tech-bro bullshit designed to take our money from us, either directly or by scamming it out of our government in the form of subsidies or commercial entities in the form of "shared costs" that are greatly in their favor.

We're realistically 18 months away from scams so realistic that they will change the course of elections, and the course of countries. And we're stuck paying for it even when we don't want to. This is just the next scam that is looting our government, our businesses, and our personal bank accounts without anyone asking us if we want it.

u/Sagrilarus • 1 points • 2025-08-20 19:20 UTC

At some point the "AI" spell is going to wear off and all of this processing power is to going to be sitting there doing nothing. The tech bros can only keep the hype up for so long.

u/Swimming-Challenge53 • 2 points • 2025-08-20 18:00 UTC

My podcast feed is overflowing with episodes on the Energy impact of AI, and I am so tired of it. Today's episode of Open Circuit was a little different, and I enjoyed it. It's just Stephen Lacey having a conversation with MIT's Vijay Gadepally (no Jigar Shah or Katherine Hamilton in attendance for this one).

[<https://www.latitudemedia.com/news/open-circuit-how-ai-is-changing-our-digital-energy-footprints/>]
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u/Potential_Ice4388 • 4 points • 2025-08-20 17:55 UTC

I like where your head's at, but i want to make sure it's known we're not the problem. Big tech and politicians in their payroll are. It's akin to asking people to use public transit while billionaires are taking private jets to everywhere.

That said, to answer your question - we can't tell for sure because there's a transparency issue
<https://finance-commerce.com/2025/08/ai-data-centers-water-use/>

Ultimately, better policies is the answer to all our problems. But people aren't unified enough to vote in systemic improvements.

u/JazzlikeAd8934 • 1 points • 2025-08-20 18:15 UTC

i heard that 🙌 i've been staying mindful about how much i use things like AI, how much data i store or harvest by regulating my phone and computer storage and staying aware of my electronic use. it'd be nice to install one of those plugins that monitors your energy usage on my pc.

u/Sagrilarus • 1 points • 2025-08-20 19:36 UTC

What corporate entity has convinced you that you're the cause of this? Huge amounts of the processing, power and water consumption are for AI models and usage that will ultimately fail. People in the industry are hoping for a 0.5% success rate long-term. That is, 99.5% of all modeling going on, consuming obscene amounts of resources, are more or less scheduled to fail, and the rich people doing this are working that into their business model. This is a panic effort to remain obscenely rich.

Did you wake up one morning and think to yourself, "gee, I hope somebody completely screws up our power grids in the hopes of being the last man standing in a massive money grab"? You didn't. This isn't on any of us. We're victims here.